ATTAWAT ASSAVANADDA (馬臣義)

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ACADEMIC PROFILE

Political scientist specialising in international relations of East and Southeast Asia. My research combines qualitative interviews, field observations, survey experiments, and statistical analysis to examine how identity, public diplomacy, and strategic communication shape perceptions of foreign powers, particularly China and the United States. My research and teaching interests encompass international relations, political psychology, public opinion, and research methods, supported by teaching experience at the University of Hong Kong and recognition as an Associate Fellow of Advance HE (the United Kingdom).

EDUCATION

PhD Political Science, The University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong SAR, 2026
Supervisors: Austin Strange (primary); Kai Quek (secondary)
Dissertation: Three Essays on Chinese Ethnicity and Attitudes Towards China: Psychological Insights from Thailand
Examining Committee: Dove H. Levin, Enze Han, Alice Ba (external examiner)

MA, International Relations, Waseda University, Japan, 2020
Supervisors: Ueki Chikako Kawakatsu
BA, Political Science, Chulalongkorn University, Thailand, 2017

RESEARCH AND PUBLICATIONS

Revise and Resubmit

- "Yes, we are family, but ...": Sino–Thais' nuanced reception of the "China and Thailand are one family" slogan, *International Journal of Strategic Communication*.
- "Is Soft Power a Zero-sum Competition?" *International Studies Quarterly* (with Austin Strange and Samuel Chan).

Under Review

- "Three-dimensional outcomes of moral-identity branding in foreign political marketing: Experimental evidence from China's public diplomacy in Thailand"
- "What does China's rise mean to ethnic Chinese overseas? A qualitative study of Sino-Thais"
- "Chineseness across Borders: Sino-Thai Identity and Transnational Political Affinity towards China"
- "When Do Foreign Publics Welcome China's Public Diplomacy? Evidence from a Survey Experiment in Thailand" (Research Note)
- "Sino-Thai Views of New Chinese Migrants in Thailand: Conditional Co-Ethnic Affinity" (Research Report)

Work-in-progress

- "China's digital public diplomacy in the Global South: State of the field and ways forward." Book chapter accepted for inclusion in the *Research Handbook on Communication in China,* edited by Dechun Zhang and Jun Liu (Edward Elgar).
- "Popular hedging in Thailand: The societal foundations of strategic flexibility amid Sino-US rivalry." With Paul Busbarat
- "Telling China's stories well? Digital diplomacy, narrative strategies, and Chinese embassies' Facebook communication in Southeast Asia, 2018–2025." With Mon Madomitsu and Maria Elize H. Mendoza.
- "Who are we to each other? Conceptualising discursive construction of interstate bilateral relations." With Gao Xirui

Policy and other writing

- "Soft power, deterrence, and South Korea's national security," in *Shaping the Future of Security on the Korean Peninsula: Next-Generation Policy Perspectives*. New York: National Committee on American Foreign Policy, 2025.
- "Thailand's Brain Drain Challenge: Trends and Implications," *Issues & Insights* Vol. 23, SR6. Honolulu, HI: Pacific Forum, 2023.
- Review of China's Asian Dream: Empire Building along the New Silk Road by Tom Miller. *International Journal of China Studies* 9(2), 2018.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

The University of Hong Kong — School of Future Media

Tutor, CCCH9062 Encoding and Decoding China in International News, Spring 2025–26
(with Prof. Alejandro Reyes)

- **Overall Tutoring Effectiveness: 93.6%**; 118 enrolled students.
- Designed and implemented activity-based classes developing media literacy and critical thinking through analysis of global media reporting on China.
- Mentored student presentations and teamwork through training, rehearsals, group projects, and discussion.

The University of Hong Kong — Department of Politics and Public Administration

Tutor, POLI3052 International Relations of East Asia, Spring 2022–23
(with Prof. Enze Han)

- **Overall Tutoring Effectiveness: 86.4%**; 104 enrolled students.
- Designed and implemented discussion-based classes using current research on East Asian international relations and current research to contemporary East Asian issues.
- Developed students' communication, debate, and research skills through group discussion and short quizzes.

Teaching Certifications

- Associate Fellow, Advance HE (UK)
- HKU Certificate in Teaching and Learning in Higher Education.

SELECTED CONFERENCES, TALKS, AND WORKSHOPS

- American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, 2024, 2025, 2026.
- International Studies Association Annual Convention, 2025, 2026, 2027 (accepted).
- International Studies Association Asia-Pacific Conference, 2023; 2026 (accepted).
- International Political Science Association World Congress, 2025.
- Selected workshops: SEAREG (2025); APSA Southeast Asia Research Development Group (2024, 2025); ASEAS-UK PhD Workshop (2025); CUHK Workshop on Political Psychology in East Asia (2024).
- Selected policy symposia: Manila Dialogue on the South China Sea (2024); Pacific Forum Research Showcase (2024); NCAFP Next-Generation Korean Peninsula Specialists (2024); US-ASEAN Futures Symposium (2023).

SCHOLARSHIPS, AWARDS, AND ACADEMIC TRAINING

Major Scholarships and Awards

- HKU Postgraduate Scholarship, 2021–2025.
- Japanese Government Scholarship (MEXT), 2018–2020.
- SEAREG Fellowship, 2025 (full sponsorship).
- Selected additional awards and support: APSA SEA-RDG awards (2024, 2025); HKU travel and departmental support; NCAFP sponsorship (2024); Hong Kong Government Reaching Out Award (2023); IPSA Travel Grant (2023); Haraguchi Memorial Asia Research Fund Research Grant (2019).

Major Scholarships and Awards

- Short-term Visiting PhD Student, University of British Columbia, Vancouver, 2025.
- IPSA Pre-Conference Methods Workshop, "Text as Data," Seoul, 2025.
- IPSA–NUS Methods School, "Modern Regression Analysis," Singapore, 2024.
- HKU Methods Hub, "Quantitative Data Analysis in the Social Sciences," Hong Kong, 2024.
- HKU Graduate School, Qualitative Research Methods Workshops, Hong Kong, 2024.
- IPSA–NUS Methods School, "Survey Research" and "Mixed Methods Research," Singapore, 2023.
- New York University Shanghai, "Introduction to Computational Social Science," Shanghai, 2023.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2020–2021	Research Assistant, German-Southeast Asian Center of Excellence for Public Policy and Good Governance, Thammasat University
2018	Research Assistant, Chinese Studies Centre, Institute of Asian Studies, Chulalongkorn University
2017–2018	Political Analyst, Government House of Thailand, Office of the Advisor to the Deputy Prime Minister for Security Affairs
2016	Research Intern, The University of New South Wales

EXTERNAL AFFILIATIONS AND PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

2021-Present	Pacific Forum —Young Leader
2024-2025	National Committee on American Foreign Policy — Next-Generation Korean Peninsula Specialist
2022-2023	Young China Watchers International — Global Editorial Team

ACADEMIC SERVICE AND MEMBERSHIPS

Reviewer:	Review of International Studies.
Memberships:	APSA, IPSA, ISA, ASEAS-UK, International Society of Political Psychology (ISPP), Association for Asian Studies (AAS).

METHODS, SOFTWARE, AND LANGUAGES

Methods:	survey and experimental research; regression analysis; mixed methods; interviews and qualitative research; thematic analysis; computational social science; text-as-data.
Software:	RStudio, Stata, SPSS, Qualtrics XM.
Languages:	Thai (native); English (professional); Mandarin Chinese (upper intermediate); Cantonese (conversational); Japanese (conversational).

Fieldwork and research travel: Taiwan (2020); Thailand (February and July–August 2024).

REFEREES

Austin Strange	Assoc. Prof., The University of Hong Kong | astrange@hku.hk
Dov Levin	Assoc. Prof., The University of Hong Kong | dovlvn@hku.hk
Enze Han	Assoc. Prof., The University of Hong Kong | enzehan@hku.hk (also Teaching Referee)
Kai Ostwald	Assoc. Prof., University of British Columbia | kai.ostwald@ubc.ca